

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 14

Group 14 Vocabulary

1. Acquiesce

Meaning: To accept or agree without protest.

Tip to remember: Acquiesce sounds like “quiet yes.” If you acquiesce, you quietly say yes.

Sentence: After a long discussion, he finally acquiesced to the committee’s decision.

2. Adroit

Meaning: Skillful, clever, and quick in action or thought.

Tip to remember: Think of a skilled Android robot doing tasks perfectly. Adroit means skillful.

Sentence: She gave an adroit answer during the interview.

3. Amend

Meaning: To improve, correct, or make changes to something.

Tip to remember: Amend sounds like “a mend.” When you mend something, you fix it.

Sentence: The researcher amended the paper after receiving reviewer comments.

4. Animus

Meaning: Strong hostility or dislike.

Tip to remember: Animus sounds like “enemy mood.” It means a hostile feeling toward someone.

Sentence: His speech showed clear animus toward his opponents.

5. Apologist

Meaning: A person who defends or supports a belief, action, or idea.

Tip to remember: Apologist sounds like apology, but it does not mean saying sorry. It means defending something.

Sentence: He became an apologist for the controversial policy.

6. Astringent

Meaning: Harsh, severe, or sharply critical; also, causing contraction of body tissues.

Tip to remember: Think of strong mouthwash that makes your mouth tighten. Astringent criticism feels sharp and tightening.

Sentence: The editor made several astringent comments about the weak argument.

7. **Collaborate**
Meaning: To work together with others.
Tip to remember: “Co” means together, and “labor” means work. Collaborate means to work together.
Sentence: The students collaborated on a renewable energy project.
8. **Competent**
Meaning: Having enough skill, ability, or knowledge to do something well.
Tip to remember: A competent person can complete the task properly.
Sentence: A competent engineer checks every detail before approving a design.
9. **Correlate**
Meaning: To show a relationship or connection between two things.
Tip to remember: Think of two variables moving together on a graph. They correlate.
Sentence: The study tried to correlate study time with GRE scores.
10. **Deride**
Meaning: To mock, ridicule, or laugh at with contempt.
Tip to remember: Deride sounds like “the ride” where people laugh at someone unfairly.
Sentence: His classmates derided his unusual idea, but it later proved useful.
11. **Dictate**
Meaning: To order or command; to say words for someone else to write down.
Tip to remember: A dictator dictates orders. Dictate means to command.
Sentence: The rules dictate that all students must submit the form on time.
12. **Discreet**
Meaning: Careful, tactful, and able to keep things private.
Tip to remember: Discreet people keep secrets discrete, or separate from public knowledge.
Sentence: She was discreet about her friend’s personal problem.
13. **Divorced**
Meaning: Separated or disconnected from something.
Tip to remember: In GRE, divorced often means separated from reality, facts, or context.
Sentence: His theory was divorced from practical experience.
14. **Elitist**
Meaning: Believing that a small, superior group should have power or influence.
Tip to remember: Elitist comes from elite. An elitist thinks only elite people matter.
Sentence: The policy was criticized as elitist because it ignored ordinary citizens.
15. **Exacting**
Meaning: Very demanding and requiring great care or effort.

Tip to remember: Exacting comes from exact. Exacting work demands exact details.
Sentence: The exacting professor expected perfect calculations.

16. **Flummoxed**

Meaning: Confused or puzzled.

Tip to remember: Think of your mind getting mixed like a messy box. When you are flummoxed, you are confused.

Sentence: The tricky GRE sentence completion question left him flummoxed.

17. **Fruitful**

Meaning: Productive, useful, or successful.

Tip to remember: A fruitful tree gives fruit. A fruitful discussion gives good results.

Sentence: Their collaboration proved fruitful and led to a published paper.

18. **Inborn**

Meaning: Existing naturally from birth; innate.

Tip to remember: Inborn means born in you. It is natural, not learned later.

Sentence: She seemed to have an inborn talent for music.

19. **Polymath**

Meaning: A person with knowledge in many different fields.

Tip to remember: “Poly” means many, and “math” here means learning. A polymath learns many things.

Sentence: Leonardo da Vinci is often called a polymath.

20. **Reticent**

Meaning: Quiet, reserved, and unwilling to speak freely.

Tip to remember: Reticent sounds like “silent.” A reticent person does not talk much.

Sentence: He was reticent during the group discussion.

21. **Stringent**

Meaning: Strict, precise, and demanding.

Tip to remember: Stringent sounds like “strong rules.” Stringent rules are strict rules.

Sentence: The laboratory followed stringent safety standards.

22. **Subservient**

Meaning: Too willing to obey others; lower in position or importance.

Tip to remember: Sub means under, and servant means one who serves. Subservient means acting like an obedient servant.

Sentence: He refused to be subservient to an unfair manager.

23. **Surreptitious**

Meaning: Done secretly, especially because it is wrong.

Tip to remember: Think of someone secretly slipping a note under a desk. That action is surreptitious.

Sentence: The student took a surreptitious look at his phone during the exam.

24. **Tantalizing**
Meaning: Very tempting or attractive but difficult to obtain.
Tip to remember: Think of tasty food placed just out of reach. It is tantalizing.
Sentence: The university offered him a tantalizing scholarship opportunity.
25. **Tantamount**
Meaning: Equivalent in effect or value.
Tip to remember: Tantamount sounds like “same amount.” It means equal in practical meaning.
Sentence: Ignoring safety rules is tantamount to inviting disaster.
26. **Torpor**
Meaning: A state of physical or mental inactivity; laziness or dullness.
Tip to remember: Torpor sounds like “tired poor.” A person in torpor feels too dull to act.
Sentence: The hot afternoon filled the classroom with torpor.
27. **Trenchant**
Meaning: Sharp, clear, and strongly effective, especially in criticism.
Tip to remember: Think of a sharp trench-cutting tool. Trenchant criticism cuts deeply and clearly.
Sentence: The reviewer gave a trenchant analysis of the weak manuscript.
28. **Umbrage**
Meaning: Offense, resentment, or annoyance.
Tip to remember: Think of someone saying, “I am angry under this shade of insult.” Umbrage means feeling offended.
Sentence: She took umbrage at his rude comment.
29. **Versatile**
Meaning: Able to do many different things well.
Tip to remember: Versatile sounds like “various styles.” A versatile person can work in various styles.
Sentence: Python is a versatile programming language.
30. **Wayward**
Meaning: Difficult to control; unpredictable or disobedient.
Tip to remember: Wayward means going away from the proper way.
Sentence: The teacher tried to guide the wayward student back to discipline.